Research and Evidence Report

Executive summary

This report supports a two-page address by the Speaker of the Parliament of the United Republic of Tanzania at an IPU meeting. The latest accessible country-level evidence reviewed is the U.S. Department of State 2025 Trafficking in Persons Report, covering April 2024–March 2025. It is an external annual assessment, not a national prevalence survey. Its reported government counts and NGO/international-organisation counts are separate systems. No reliable national prevalence estimate was located.

The strongest verified parliamentary contribution is legislative: the Anti-Trafficking in Persons Act, 2008 was amended by the enacted Written Laws (Miscellaneous Amendments) (No. 2) Act, 2024 (Act No. 14 of 2024), which established a statutory Anti-Trafficking in Persons Secretariat. A 2025 official consolidation incorporates the amendment. No exact trafficking-specific Hansard quotation or leadership directive was verified in the material accessed; neither is attributed in the speech.

Situation and patterns

- The 2025 TIP Report describes Tanzania as a country of origin, transit and destination. It reports trafficking of Tanzanian and foreign nationals, internally and across borders.
- Documented exploitation patterns include forced labour in domestic work, agriculture, mining, fishing, begging and other services; sex trafficking; child domestic servitude; and exploitation of children and persons with disabilities. Specific descriptions are reported patterns, not prevalence estimates.
- Recruitment can involve false promises of work, education or marriage, family/community intermediaries, unregistered employment agents, fraudulent online job advertisements and social-media contact. Debt associated with travel, documents or accommodation can be used as coercion.
- The report identifies internal and regional movement, including Lake Victoria networks and migration routes to the Middle East and other African countries. Migrant women and girls, rural children, orphans, people with disabilities, refugees and workers recruited through informal channels face specific risks.
- The evidence does not establish that poverty, unemployment or migration alone causes trafficking. These conditions can increase exposure to deceptive recruitment and reduce options for safe exit; responsibility remains with perpetrators.

Statistics and what they mean

- 2025 TIP period (April 2024–March 2025): Government reported 7 trafficking investigations, initiated prosecutions of 10 defendants (9 charged under the 2008 Act and 1 under an unspecified law), and 4 convictions (3 under the Act and 1 under an unspecified law). It identified 33 victims: 10 in sex trafficking, 17 in labour trafficking and 6 in other exploitation; 20 children and 13 adult women; 20 Tanzanian and 13 Burundian nationals; 8 people with disabilities. NGOs and international organisations reported identifying an additional 94 victims. These are not a single combined national count.
- 2024 TIP period (April 2023–March 2024): Government reported 8 investigations, 5 prosecutions involving 6 alleged traffickers, no convictions, and 54 identified victims (35 sex trafficking, 19 labour trafficking; 35 children and 19 adult women; 51 Tanzanian and 3 Burundian nationals; 6 people with disabilities). NGOs/international organisations reported an additional 48 victims.
- The reports explicitly describe the absence of a centralised law-enforcement data system and incomplete coverage of victim identification. The 2025 TIP report says the government data covered shelters with formal ATS MOUs. Changes between reporting years must not be interpreted as a national trend or prevalence change without accounting for coverage and methodology.
- Anti-trafficking appropriations cited in the TIP reports rose from TZS 563.8 million in 2023 to TZS 663 million in 2024. These are reported allocations to the Anti-Trafficking Secretariat for programmes, not measured expenditure or evidence of service outcomes.
- No national prevalence estimate, fully comparable 2020–2026 series, or complete national case count was verified. The 2025 TIP report was the latest country-specific annual report found; no 2026 TIP report was available in the source review.

Legislative and institutional response

- The Anti-Trafficking in Persons Act, 2008 (Act No. 6 of 2008), commenced 1 February 2009 and applies to Mainland Tanzania and Zanzibar (section 2). It criminalises trafficking-related conduct, provides for identification, rescue, care, compensation, victim protection and an Anti-Trafficking Fund. The law's amendments must be read with the 2025 official consolidated text, which includes Acts No. 1 of 2013, 9 of 2021 and 14 of 2024 among others.
- The 2024 amendment (Act No. 14 of 2024) added a statutory Secretariat. In the 2025 official consolidation, section 26 assigns it interagency coordination, prevention, training, joint investigations, victim rescue/protection/rehabilitation/reintegration, implementation of relevant international agreements, safe-house coordination, research and cooperation. Sections 31–32 address parliamentary appropriations as a source of the Fund and victim needs, training, family tracing, rehabilitation and reintegration as uses.
- The Law of the Child Act, 2009 (Act No. 21 of 2009), supports child rights, welfare, protection and employment regulation. The Employment and Labour Relations Act, 2004 and recruitment oversight frameworks are relevant to forced labour and safe migration. Detailed clause-by-clause treatment of these related laws was not attempted where consolidated text was not directly verified.
- The Constitution provides equality, freedom and rights protections and gives Parliament legislative and supervisory functions. Parliament's practical responsibilities include scrutinising implementation, reviewing agency performance, considering appropriations, representing affected communities and conducting parliamentary diplomacy. These general responsibilities are distinct from specific interventions.
- The 2024 Act is a concrete legislative intervention enacted by Parliament. The 2025 assessment also records that ATS had operationalised an office in Zanzibar during its reporting period, but notes ongoing coordination, protection and capacity needs. The speech therefore stresses delivery and accountability rather than claiming that institutional creation alone solved the problem.

Parliamentary record and leadership statements

- The Parliament of Tanzania Hansard portal was reviewed and searches were attempted for English and Kiswahili terms including trafficking in persons, usafirishaji haramu wa binadamu and biashara ya binadamu. The portal did not produce an accessible transcript with a verifiable trafficking-specific statement during this review. A 3 September 2024 official Order Paper and the enacted Act No. 14 of 2024 document the bill/process and enacted legislative result, but neither is treated as a verbatim Hansard speech.
- Accordingly, the Hansard extract file records the search limitation and the primary legislative evidence; it does not invent a quotation or falsely label the Order Paper as Hansard. Before official delivery, Parliament's Clerk/Hansard office should be asked to verify any desired quotations from the relevant 2024 bill proceedings or earlier questions and committee reports.
- No explicit human-trafficking directive by the President, Zanzibar President, Prime Minister, Vice-President or responsible minister was verified in the public primary records accessed. The speech makes no leader attribution. Related policy and institutional actions are reported only as actions documented in the TIP reports or enacted law.

Treaty commitments

- Verified treaty records include Tanzania's ratification of the Palermo Protocol on 24 May 2006 (entry into force 23 June 2006), CRC ratification on 10 June 1991, CEDAW ratification on 20 August 1985, accession to the CRC Optional Protocol on sale of children on 24 April 2003, and ILO C29/C105 ratifications on 30 January 1962 and C182 on 12 September 2001. Tanzania ratified the African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child on 16 March 2003 (deposit 9 May 2003), and the African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights on 18 February 1984.
- Tanzania is a party to UNTOC; the exact action date was not transcribed from the UNTC page in this research and should be checked in the live depositary record for any formal citation. Tanzania had not ratified ILO Convention No. 189 as at the NORMLEX access date. The workbook lists instruments, action dates, status and source links; treaty status is not inferred from domestic law.

Challenges and parliamentary opportunities

- Latest reporting identifies inadequate or inconsistently applied victim screening, limited victim-witness assistance and shelter capacity, over-reliance on civil society for victim services, incomplete central data, uneven interagency referral, law-enforcement capacity and recruitment-agency oversight gaps, and risks of victims being detained, deported or penalised without adequate screening.

- Parliament can follow up on the 2024 statutory changes by asking whether the Secretariat is staffed and funded, how Mainland and Zanzibar functions are coordinated, whether a central case-and-victim data system is operational, how the national referral mechanism and survivor services are being implemented, and whether labour recruitment channels are monitored. Budget scrutiny should distinguish appropriations from disbursements, services delivered and measurable outcomes.

Research caveats and verification protocol

- Status labels: VERIFIED means an accessible authoritative primary record or direct text was inspected; CORROBORATED means supported by an authoritative annual report plus its source mirror; PARTIALLY VERIFIED means evidence is real but an archival, scope or status detail remains uncertain. UNVERIFIED claims are excluded from the speech.
- The State Department's primary 2025 report page returned access denial in this environment; its full published text was inspected through the ecoi.net mirror, and the official URL is provided. The official law PDF from the Government of Tanzania was downloaded and text-extracted. The IOM action-plan PDF is image-based and could not be text-extracted; its title/period and landing page are verified, but substantive claims from its body are not quoted.
- There is a material plan-status discrepancy: IOM's landing page publishes a National Action Plan titled 2023–2028, while the 2025 TIP report refers to the concluded 2021–2024 plan and recommends developing a successor. Do not characterize the IOM-hosted 2023–2028 document as an officially adopted successor without confirming the Government's formal status and any Zanzibar implementation arrangements.
- Research was conducted for drafting support, not as legal advice. The Parliament/Hansard office, Ministry responsible for Home Affairs and Government legal counsel should validate speech timing, institutional nomenclature, current budget figures and any additional primary records before official use.

Selected references (APA-style)

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